STAT 547 Lecture Notes

Probability Theory

University of British Columbia

Jiajun Zhang
Department of Statistics
September 2026

Contents

1 Basics of Measure Theory **2**
- 1.1 Preliminaries . . . 2
- 1.2 σ-algebras . . . 4
- 1.3 Measurable Functions . . . 6
- 1.4 Measures . . . 9
- 1.5 Integration . . . 13
  - 1.5.1 Construction of integral . . . 13
  - 1.5.2 Convergence Theorems . . . 16
- 1.6 Radon-Nikodym theorem . . . 19
- 1.7 Kernels . . . 21
- 1.8 Product spaces . . . 23

2 Probability Spaces **25**
- 2.1 Basics of probability spaces . . . 25
- 2.2 Expectations . . . 27
- 2.3 Joint distributions . . . 28
- 2.4 Independence . . . 30

3 Bibliography **31**

1 Basics of Measure Theory

1.1 Preliminaries

We assume E is a state space, let $\{A_i\}_{i\in\mathcal{I}} \subset E$ be a sequence of sets in E, then the **intersection** and **union** of those sets are defined as

$$\bigcup_{i\in\mathcal{I}} A_i := \{x \in E, \exists i : x \in A_i\}; \quad \bigcap_{i\in\mathcal{I}} A_i := \{x \in E, \forall A_i, x \in A_i\}.$$

The union can be understood as "*there exists*", and the intersection can be understood as "*for all*". The **compliment** of A, denote as A^C, is defined by $A^C := E \setminus A$. The DeMorgan's law on sets states that if we have a collection of sets $A_i \in \mathcal{C}$, then

$$\left(\bigcup_{A\in\mathcal{C}} A\right)^C = \bigcap_{A\in\mathcal{C}} A^C; \quad \left(\bigcap_{A\in\mathcal{C}} A\right)^C = \bigcup_{A\in\mathcal{C}} A^C.$$

Definition 1. Given a sequence $\{x_n\}_{n\in\mathbb{N}} \subset \mathbb{R}$, the **limsup** and **liminf** of that sequence are defiend by

$$\limsup_n x_n := \lim_{n\to\infty} \sup_{k\geq n} x_k; \quad \liminf_n x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} \inf_{k\geq n} x_k.$$

Note that $\sup_{k\geq n} x_k$ is decreasing as a function of n, hence limsup can also be written as

$$\limsup_n x_n = \inf_n \sup_{k\geq n} x_k.$$

Similarly for liminf, since $\inf_{k\geq n} x_k$ is increasing as a function of n, we then have

$$\liminf_n x_n = \sup_n \inf_{k\geq n} x_k.$$

The limit of $\lim_n x_n$ exists if and only if

$$\limsup_n x_n = \liminf_x x_n = \lim_n x_n.$$

The definition of limsup and liminf can be extended to sets:

Definition 2. Let $\{A_n\}_{n\in\mathbb{N}} \subset E$ be a sequence of sets, then the limsup and liminf of that sequence are defined by

$$\limsup_n A_n = \bigcap_n \bigcup_{k\geq n} A_k; \quad \liminf_n A_n = \bigcup_n \bigcap_{k\geq n} A_k.$$

We can interpret them as follow:

- $x \in \limsup_n A_n$ if and only if $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}$, $\exists k \geq n$, such that $x \in A_k$. We say $x \in A_k$ *infinitely often*;
- $x \in \liminf_n A_n$ if and only if there $\exists n \in \mathbb{N}$, such that $x \in A_k$ for all $k \geq n$. We say $x \in A_k$ *eventually*.

Similarly, $\lim_n A_n$ exists if and only if

$$\limsup_n A_n = \liminf_n A_n = \lim_n A_n.$$

Example 1. Let $\{A_n\}$ be defined as

$$A_n = \begin{cases} [0,1] \cup \{2\} & \text{if } n = 2^m \text{ for some } m \in \mathbb{N} \\ [0,1] & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}.$$

Then for any $N \in \mathbb{N}$, we can always find some m such that there exists $n = 2^m$ for $n \geq N$, we hence claim that the limsup of $\{A_n\}$ is $[0,1] \cup \{2\}$, i.e, the occurrence of $[0,1] \cup \{2\}$ happens infinitely often. On the other hand, we claim the liminf is $[0,1]$, since we cannot guarantee an $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\{2\} \in A_n$ for all $n \geq N$ (the appearance of $\{2\}$ gets more and more sparse as n grows). But there exists N_0, such that $[0,1] \in A_n$ for all $n \geq N_0$ (this happens eventually).

By using DeMorgan's law, we have

$$\left(\limsup_n A_n\right)^C = \left(\bigcap_n \bigcup_{k \geq n} A_k\right)^C = \bigcup_n \left(\bigcup_{k \geq n} A_k\right)^C = \bigcup_n \bigcap_{k \geq n} A_k^C := \liminf_n A_n^C,$$

and, we can play around with other notations.

Proposition 1. $x \in \limsup_n A_n$ if and only if $\limsup_n \mathbb{1}\{x \in A_n\} = 1$; and $x \in \liminf_n A_n$ if and only if $\limsup_n \mathbb{1}\{x \in A_n\} = 1$.

Proof. We first assume $x \in \limsup_n A_n$, which means $\forall n$, $x \in \bigcup_{k \geq n} A_k$. Hence we may construct a subsequence $\{A_{n_k}\}_{k=1}^{\infty}$ where $n_k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $x \in A_{n_k}, \forall k$, which implies $\limsup_n \mathbb{1}\{x \in A_n\} = 1$. The other direction follows by reversing the steps. The proof for liminf follows the same procedure. □

Proposition 2. We say a sequence $\{A_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ is **monotonically increasing** if $A_1 \subset A_2 \subset \cdots$, in this case $\lim_n A_n$ exists and

$$\lim_n A_n = \bigcup_n A_n.$$

Proof. We have that

$$\limsup_n A_n = \bigcap_{n \geq 1} \bigcup_{k \geq n} A_k = \bigcap_{n \geq 1} \bigcup_{k \geq 1} A_k = \bigcup_n A_n,$$

since $\{A_n\}$ is increasing. Also,

$$\liminf_n A_n = \bigcup_{n \geq 1} \bigcap_{k \geq n} A_k = \bigcup_{n \geq 1} A_n,$$

since $\{A_n\}$ is decreasing. □

In fact by using DeMorgan's law $\bigcup A_n^C = \bigcap A_n$, where $\{A_n\}$ is monotonically increasing, we may further conclude that if $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is **monotonically decreasing** (meaning $A_1 \supset A_2 \supset \cdots$), then $\lim_n A_n$ exists and $\lim_n A_n = \bigcap_n A_n$.

1.2 σ-algebras

Definition 3. Let E be a *non-empty* set, $\mathcal{E}$ be the collection of subsets of E, $\mathcal{E}$ is called a **σ-algebra** on E if the following holds:

- $E \in \mathcal{E}$;
- If $A \in \mathcal{E}$, then $A^C = E \setminus A \in \mathcal{E}$ (it is closed under compliments);
- If $\{A_n\}_{n\in\mathbb{N}} \subset \mathcal{E}$, then $\bigcup_{n\in\mathbb{N}} A_n \in \mathcal{E}$ (it is closed under countable unions).

We denote $(E, \mathcal{E})$ to be a **measurable space**.

From the definition above, some properties of σ-algebra follow immediately:

- $\varnothing \in \mathcal{E}$: This is because $E^C \in \mathcal{E}$;
- $\bigcap_{n\in\mathbb{N}} A_n \in \mathcal{E}$: This is because $\left(\bigcup_{n\in\mathbb{N}} A_n^C\right)^C \in \mathcal{E}$;
- It is also closed under finite unions and intersections.

Example 2. Below are some examples of σ-algebras:

- **The trivial σ-algebra**: For any non-empty set E, we say $\mathcal{E} = \{E, \varnothing\}$ is a σ-algebra (the smallest σ-algebra on E);
- For any non-empty set E, its power set 2^E is also a σ-algebra (the biggest σ-algebra on E);
- Given a collection of sets $\mathcal{C}$, denote $\sigma(\mathcal{C})$ as the *smallest* σ-algebra that contains $\mathcal{C}$. i.e, if $\mathcal{C}_1$ is another σ-algebra on $\mathcal{C}$, then $\sigma(\mathcal{C}) \subset \mathcal{C}_1$. We denote $\sigma(\mathcal{C})$ the σ-algebra **generated by $\mathcal{C}$**;
- Let E be the state space, $A, B \subset E$ be sets. Then
$$\sigma(\{A, B\}) = \{\varnothing, E, A, B, A^C, B^C, A \cap B, A \cup B\};$$
- Given two measurable space $(E, \mathcal{E}), (F, \mathcal{F})$, the product space $E \times F := (e, f), e \in E, f \in F$, and
$$\mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{F} := \sigma\{A \times B : A \in \mathcal{E}, B \in \mathcal{F}\}.$$

Definition 4. A collection $\mathcal{C}$ on E is called a ***p*-system** if $A, B \in \mathcal{C}$ implies $A \cap B \in \mathcal{C}$.

Sometimes p-system is also referred as π-system.

Definition 5. A collection $\mathcal{D}$ on E is called a ***d*-system** if it satisfies the following:

- $E \in \mathcal{D}$;
- If $A, B \in \mathcal{D}$ and $A \subset B$, then $B \setminus A \in \mathcal{D}$;
- If $A_n \nearrow A$ ($\{A_n\}$ is non-decreasing with limit A), and $A_n \in \mathcal{D}$ for all n, then $A := \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n \in \mathcal{D}$.

Proposition 3 (**Dykin's $p - d$ lemma**)**.** A collection $\mathcal{D}$ on E is a σ-algebra on E if and only if it is both a p-system and a d-system on E.

Proof. ($\Longrightarrow$): Suppose $\mathcal{D}$ is a σ-algebra on E, then trivially it is a p-system since $(A \cap B = A^C \cup B^C)^C \in \mathcal{D}$. Since $E \in \mathcal{D}$, take any $A \in E$, $A \subset E$, so $E \setminus A \in \mathcal{D}$. Finally consider an arbitrary sequence $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty} \subset \mathcal{D}$, define $B_n = \bigcup_{i=1}^{n} A_i$, then $B_n \nearrow B$ where $B = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n \in \mathcal{D}$.

($\Longleftarrow$): Suppose $\mathcal{D}$ is both a p-system and a d-system, then we already have $E \in \mathcal{D}$. If $A \in \mathcal{D}$, $A \subset E$, then $E \setminus A = A^C \in \mathcal{D}$. Finally let $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$ be an arbitrary sequence, define $B_n = \bigcup_{i=1}^{n} A_i$, then $\{B_n\}$ is non-decreasing, and $B_n \in \mathcal{D}$. This is because

$$B_n = \bigcup_{i=1}^{n} A_i = \left(\bigcap A_i^C \right)^C \in \mathcal{D},$$

since $\mathcal{D}$ is a p-system, and it is closed under finite intersection. Then by property of a d-system, $\lim_{n\to\infty} \bigcup_{i=1}^{n} B_i \in \mathcal{D}$, and note that $\bigcup_n B_n = \bigcup_n A_n$, which means $\mathcal{D}$ is closed under countable union, and it is hence a σ-algebra. □

Theorem 1 (**Monotone class theorem**)**.** If $\mathcal{C}$ is a p-system, $\mathcal{D}$ is a d-system and $\mathcal{C} \subset \mathcal{D}$, then $\sigma(\mathcal{C}) \subset \mathcal{D}$.

We need two lemmas to establish this proof.

Lemma 1. Let $\mathcal{D}$ be a d-system on E, and fix $D \in \mathcal{D}$. Deifne

$$\widehat{\mathcal{D}} = \{A \in \mathcal{D} : A \cap D \in \mathcal{D}\},$$

then $\widehat{\mathcal{D}}$ is a d-system on E.

Proof. It is easy to see that $E \in \mathcal{D}, E \cap D = D \in \mathcal{D}$, so $E \in \widehat{D}$; Let $A_1, A_2 \in \widehat{D}$, $A_1 \subset A_2$, then we have $A_1 \cap D \in \mathcal{D}, A_2 \cap D \in \mathcal{D}, A_1 \cap D \subset A_2 \cap D$, and $(A_2 \setminus A_1) \cap D = (A_2 \cap D) \setminus (A_1 \cap D) \in \widehat{D}$. Let $A_n \nearrow A$, where $A_n \in \widehat{D}$, then $A_n \cap D \nearrow A \cap D$, and

$$A \cap D = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n \cap D \in \widehat{D}.$$

□

Lemma 2. If $\mathcal{D}_1, \mathcal{D}_2$ are two d-systems on E, then so is $\mathcal{D}_1 \cap \mathcal{D}_2$.

We shall omit this proof since it is trivial.

We now prove the monotone class theorem:

Proof. Let $\mathcal{D}'$ be the smallest d-system containing $\mathcal{C}$, i.e, $\mathcal{C} \subset \mathcal{D}'$, then we have $\sigma(\mathcal{C}) \subset \sigma(\mathcal{D}')$. Hence it suffices to show $\sigma(\mathcal{D}') = \mathcal{D}'$. If $\mathcal{D}'$ is a σ-algebra, then clearly $\sigma(\mathcal{D}') = \mathcal{D}'$. Hence by proposition 3, it remains to prove $\mathcal{D}'$ is a p-system. Fix $B \in \mathcal{C}$, and define

$$\mathcal{D}_1' = \{A \in \mathcal{D}' : A \cap B \in \mathcal{D}'\},$$

then by construction and the previous lemma, $\mathcal{D}_1'$ is a d-system, hence $\subset \mathcal{D}' \subset D_1'$, which implies $\forall A \in \mathcal{D}', B \in \mathcal{C}, A \cap B \in \mathcal{D}'$. Now fix $A \in \mathcal{D}'$, define

$$\mathcal{D}_2' := \{B \in \mathcal{D}' A \cap B \in \mathcal{D}'\},$$

which is again a d-system, and $\mathcal{C} \subset D_2'$, which means $\mathcal{D}' \subset \mathcal{D}_2'$. Now we have that $\forall A, B \in \mathcal{D}'$, $A \cap B \in \mathcal{D}'$, so $\mathcal{D}'$ is a p-system. □

Next we introduce one important σ-algebra on real numbers $\mathbb{R}$:

Definition 6. The **Borel σ-algebra**, denote as $\mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R})$, is defined as

$$\mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R}) := \sigma\{\text{all open sets in } \mathbb{R}\}.$$

In fact, it can be shown that $\mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R})$ is also equal to $\sigma((a,b)); \sigma([a,b]), \sigma([a,b)), \sigma((a,b])$, etc. Open sets are the elements inside a **topology** $\mathcal{T}$. The definition of a topology follows.

Definition 7. We say $\mathcal{T}$ is a topology over S, if

- $\varnothing, S \in \mathcal{T}$;
- If $A, B \in \mathcal{T}$, then $A \cap B \in \mathcal{T}$;
- Given an arbitrary collection $A_i \in \mathcal{T}, i \in \mathcal{I}$, then $\bigcup_{i\in\mathcal{I}} A_i \in \mathcal{T}$.

If $S = \mathbb{R}$, then

$$\mathcal{T} := \left\{ \bigcup_{i\in\mathcal{I}} (a_i, b_i); a_i < b_i; a_i, b_i \in \mathbb{R} \right\} \cup \{\varnothing\}.$$

1.3 Measurable Functions

A function $f : X \to Y$ is a mapping such that for any $x \in X$, there is a unique $y \in Y$ such that $f(x) = y$. We now give the definition of a measurable function:

Definition 8. Given two measurable spaces $(E, \mathcal{E}), (F, \mathcal{F})$, the function $f : (E, \mathcal{E}) \to (F, \mathcal{F})$ is **measurable** (or $\mathcal{E}$-measurable) if for any $B \in \mathcal{F}$, its pre-image is in $\mathcal{E}$, i.e,

$$f^{-1}(B) = \{x \in E : f(x) \in B\} \in \mathcal{E}, \quad \forall B \in \mathcal{F}.$$

We often work with real valued functions $f : \mathbb{R} \to \overline{\mathbb{R}}$, where $\overline{\mathbb{R}}$ is the extended real line ($\overline{\mathbb{R}} = \mathbb{R} \cup \{-\infty\} \cup \{\infty\}$). In this setting, we consider $[-\infty, a), (b, \infty]$ as open sets. The σ-algebra we consider is simply the Borel σ-algebra $\mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R})$.

Proposition 4. The function $f : (E, \mathcal{E}) \to (F, \mathcal{F})$ is measurable if and only if there exists a collection $\mathcal{F}_0$ on F with $\sigma(\mathcal{F}_0) = \mathcal{F}$, and $f^{-1}(B) \in \mathcal{E}$ for all $B \in \mathcal{F}_0$.

Proof. $\Longrightarrow$ is trivial. We consider a collection $\mathcal{F}_0$ of subsets of F with $\sigma(\mathcal{F}_0) = \mathcal{F}$. Denote

$$\mathcal{F}_1 := \{B \in \mathcal{F}, f^{-1}(B) \in \mathcal{E}\},$$

then it is straightforward to show that $\mathcal{F}_1$ is a σ-algebra on F_1, hence $\mathcal{F}_1 = \sigma(\mathcal{F}_1) \supset \sigma(\mathcal{F}_0) = \mathcal{F}$. □

Proposition 5. The function $f : \mathbb{R} \to \overline{\mathbb{R}}$ is measurable on $\mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R})$ if and only if for all $r \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$f^{-1}([-\infty, r]) := \{x \in \mathbb{R} : f(x) \le r\} \in \mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R}).$$

Proof. $\Longrightarrow$ is trivial. Using Proposition 4, it suffices to show the Borel σ-algebra can also be generated by sets of the form $(a, b]$. For any $r \in \mathbb{R}$, we have that

$$[-\infty, r] = \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} \left[-\infty, r + \frac{1}{n}\right) \in \mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R}).$$

Recall in our setting $[-\infty, r)$ is open. □

Measurable functions have the following property as well:

Proposition 6. Let f, g be measurable functions on $(E, \mathcal{E})$, $\{f_n\}$ be a sequence of measurable functions on $(E, \mathcal{E})$. Then

- For any $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$, $af + bg$; fg; $f \circ g$; $f/g, g \neq 0$ are measurable;
- $\inf_n f_n$; $\sup_n f_n$; $\limsup_n f_n$; $\liminf_n f_n$ are measurable;

We only give the proof for a few cases.

Proof. For $af + bg$, consider any $r \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$\begin{aligned}
(af + bg)^{-1}([-\infty, r)) &= \{x \in E : af(x) + bg(x) < r\} \\
&= \{x \in E : af(x) < r - bg(x)\} \\
&= \bigcup_{q \in \mathbb{Q}} \{x \in \mathbb{R} : af(x) < q < r - bg(x)\} \\
&= \bigcup_{q \in \mathbb{Q}} \left(\{x \in E : af(x) < q\} \bigcap \{x \in E : r - bg(x) > q\} \right) \in \mathcal{E}.
\end{aligned}$$

□

Proof. For $\sup_n f_n$, take any $r \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$\begin{aligned}
\sup_n f_n^{-1}([-\infty, r]) &:= \{x \in E : \sup_n f_n(x) \leq r\} \\
&= \left\{ x \in E : \bigcap_{i=1}^{n} f_i(x) \leq r \right\} \\
&= \bigcap_{i=1}^{n} \{x \in E : f_i(x) \leq r\} \in \mathcal{E}.
\end{aligned}$$

Using the fact that $\inf_n f_n(x) = -\sup_n(-f_n(x))$, one can easily show that $\sup_n f_n$ is also measurable. Then $\liminf_n f_n$, $\limsup_n f_n$ can be written as

$$\limsup f_n = \inf_n \sup_{m \geq n} f_m, \quad \liminf f_n = \sup_n \inf_{m \geq n} f_m,$$

and hence they are also measurable. □

We now introduce a class of measurable functions called **simple functions**:

Definition 9 (**Simple Functions**). A function $f : (E, \mathcal{E}) \to (F, \mathcal{F})$ is said to be simple, if it takes the form

$$f(x) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i \mathbb{1}_{A_i},$$

where $a_1, \cdots, a_n \in \mathbb{R}$, $A_i \subset \mathcal{E}$.

The $\mathbb{1}_A(\cdot)$ is the **indicator function** on set A, it is defined by

$$\mathbb{1}_A(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & x \in A \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}.$$

Clearly, for a simple function f, there exists $b_1, \cdots, b_m \in \mathbb{R}$ and $B_1, \cdots, B_m \in \mathcal{E}$ a partition of $\mathcal{E}$, such that $f(x) = \sum_{j=1}^{m} b_j \mathbb{1}_{B_j}(x)$. It is called the **canonical form** of the simple function f.

The reason for introducing simple functions is because it can be used to approximate measurable functions.

Theorem 2. A positive function $f : (E, \mathcal{E}) \to (F, \mathcal{F})$ is measurable if and only if it is the limit of an increasing sequence of positive simple functions.

Proof. $(\Longleftarrow)$ is trivial. We start by introducing a sequence of function $\{d_n\}$: For any $x \in \overline{\mathbb{R}}^+$, define

$$d_n(x) := \sum_{k=1}^{n2^n} \frac{k-1}{2^n} \cdot \mathbb{1}_{\left[\frac{k-1}{2^n}, \frac{k}{2^n}\right)}(x) + n \cdot \mathbb{1}_{[n,\infty]}(x).$$

The graph of $d_n(x)$ is given as follow:

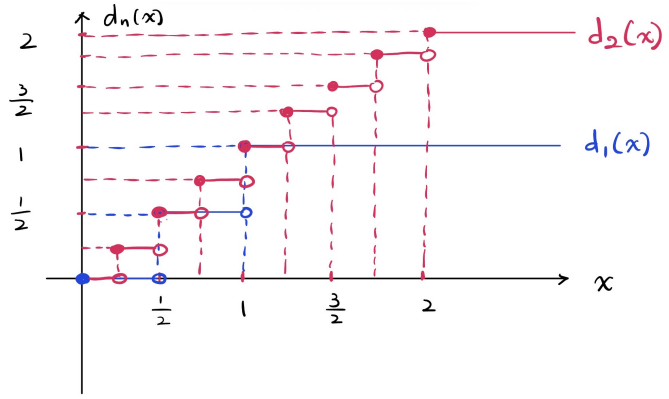


Figure 1: The graphical illustration of $d_n(x)$, with n specifically chosen to be 1 and 2.

We claim that for each n, $d_n(x)$ is a non-decreasing, right continuous simple function, and $\forall x \in \overline{\mathbb{R}}^+$, $d_n(x) \nearrow x$. Now we compose $d_n(\cdot)$ with f, and let

$$f_n(x) = d_n(f(x)).$$

Then by the properties of $d_n(x)$ and f, f_n is measurable, positive, and simple. Furthermore

$$f(x) = \lim_{n \to \infty} f_n(x),$$

and f is measurable, which is the limit of a sequence of positive simple functions. □

In general, given a function f, we may decompose f as

$$f = f^+ - f^-,$$

where $f^+ := \max\{f, 0\}$, and $f^- : \max\{-f, 0\}$.

Definition 10. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a collection of (numerical) functions on E. Denote $\mathcal{M}^+$ as the subcollection containing positive functions in $\mathcal{M}$, and $\mathcal{M}_b$ as the subcollection of bounded functions in $\mathcal{M}$. Then $\mathcal{M}$ is called a **monotone class** if

- $1 \in \mathcal{M}$;
- If $f, g \in \mathcal{M}_b$, $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$ then $af + bg \in \mathcal{M}$;
- If $\{f_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty} \in \mathcal{M}^+$ and $f_n \nearrow f$, then $f \in \mathcal{M}$.

We have a monotone class theorem for functions. The theorem next can be used to show that a certain property holds for all $\mathcal{E}$-measurable functions.

Theorem 3 (**Monotone class theorem for functions**)**.** Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a monotone class of functions on E. Suppose that for some p-system $\mathcal{C}$ generating $\mathcal{E}$, such that $\mathbb{1}_A \in \mathcal{M}$ for every $A \in \mathcal{C}$, then $\mathcal{M}$ includes all positive $\mathcal{E}$-measurable functions and all bounded $\mathcal{E}$-measurable functions.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{D} := \{A \in \mathcal{E} : 1_A \in \mathcal{M}\}$. Then it is easy to prove that $\mathcal{D}$ is a d-system. By assumption, $\mathcal{D} \supset \mathcal{C}$, and $\mathcal{C}$ is a p-system that generates $\mathcal{E}$, then by monotone class theorem we have $\mathcal{D} \supset \mathcal{E}$, hence $\mathbb{1}_A \in \mathcal{M}$ for every $A \in \mathcal{E}$. In this case using the definition of a monotone class of functions, all simple functions are contained in $\mathcal{M}$. Let f be a positive $\mathcal{E}$-measurable functions, then there exists a sequence of positive simple functions $\{f_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty} \subset \mathcal{M}^+$ such that $f_n \nearrow f$, hence $f \in \mathcal{M}$. Finally let f be bounded $\mathcal{E}$-measurable functions, use $f = f^+ - f^-$, we know both f^+, f^- are positive and bounded, hence $f \in \mathcal{M}$. □

1.4 Measures

Let $(E, \mathcal{E})$ be a measurable space, a **measure** on $(E, \mathcal{E})$ is a function $\mu : \mathcal{E} \to [0, \infty]$ with certain properties. We now formally define a measure:

Definition 11. A measure μ on $(E, \mathcal{E})$ is a non-negative mapping $\mu : \mathcal{E} \mapsto [0, \infty]$ such that

- $\mu(E') \geq 0$, for all $E' \in \mathcal{E}$;
- $\mu(\varnothing) = 0$;
- (*Countable additivity*) If $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty} \subset \mathcal{E}$ are disjoint, then

$$\mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu(A_n).$$

Note that countable additivity automatically implies finite additivity.

With measure μ on the measurable space $(E, \mathcal{E})$ defined, we denote the triple $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ a **measure space**.

We will see some examples of different measures.

Example 3. Below, denote $(E, \mathcal{E})$ the measurable space.

- **Dirac measure**: Fix $x \in \mathcal{E}$, and for any $A \in \mathcal{E}$, the Dirac measure on x is defined by
$$\delta_x(A) := \begin{cases} 1 & x \in A; \\ 0 & x \notin A \end{cases}.$$
- **Counting measure**: Fix $D \subset E$, and for any $A \in \mathcal{E}$, the counting measure on D is defined by
$$\nu_D(A) = \begin{cases} |D \cap A| & \text{if } |D| \text{ is countable;} \\ \infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$
- **Discrete measure**: Fix $D \subset E$ be countable, and $\forall x \in D$, define $\omega_x \geq 0$, then for any $A \in \mathcal{E}$, the counting measure on D is defined by
$$\mu(A) = \sum_{x \in D} \omega_x \delta_x(A).$$
- **Lebesgue measure**: The Lebesgue measure, $\text{Leb}(\cdot)$ on $(\mathbb{R}, \mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R}))$, maps each interval to its length. That is, for any $a, b \in \mathbb{R}, a < b$,
$$\text{Leb}((a,b)) = \text{Leb}([a,b]) = \text{Leb}((a,b]) = \text{Leb}([a,b)) = b - a,$$
and singletons have Lebesgue measure 0.
- **Probability measure**: If μ is a probability measure on $(E, \mathcal{E})$, then $\mu(E) = 1$, and E is referred as the sample space.

Based on Definition 11, we are able to derive more properties about a measure μ on $(E, \mathcal{E})$:

Proposition 7. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measure space, then the followings hold:

- **Monotonicity**: If $A \subset B \in \mathcal{E}$, then $\mu(A) \leq \mu(B)$;
- **Countable subadditivity**: Let $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty} \in \mathcal{E}$ be an arbitrary sequence of sets, then
$$\mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) \leq \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu(A_n).$$

Note that countable subadditivity automatically implies finite subadditivity.

Proof. Assume $A \subset B \in \mathcal{E}$. If one of them has measure ∞ then the result follows trivially. Hence suppose $\mu(A), \mu(B) < \infty$, moreover
$$\mu(B) = \mu(A) + \mu(B \setminus A) \geq \mu(A).$$
Let $B_1 := A_1$, and $B_n := A_n \setminus \left(\bigcup_{i=1}^{n-1} A_i\right)$ for every $n \geq 2$, then we know that $\{B_n, n \geq 1\} \subset \mathcal{E}$ and B_n's are disjoint. More importantly, by our construction we have $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} B_n = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n$. Thus by countable additivity, we have
$$\mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} B_n\right) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu(B_n) \leq \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu(A_n).$$
□

Consider a monotonic sequence $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty} \in \mathcal{E}$, then we also have the following:

Proposition 8 (**Continuity From Below**). Given $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty} \in \mathcal{E}$, and $A_n \subset A_{n+1}$ (A_n is increasing) for every n. Denote $\lim_n A_n = A$, then

$$\mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \lim_{n\to\infty} \mu(A_n) = \mu(A).$$

Proof. Set $B_1 = A_1$, $B_n = A_n \backslash B_{n-1}$ for all $n \geq 2$. By definition $\{B_n, n \geq 1\} \subset \mathcal{E}$ are disjoint, and we have $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} B_n = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n$; also for each $N \geq 1$, $\bigcup_{n=1}^{N} B_n = A_n$, which means

$$\begin{aligned}\mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} B_n\right) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu(B_n) &= \lim_{N\to\infty} \sum_{n=1}^{N} \mu(B_n) \\ &= \lim_{N\to\infty} \mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{N} B_n\right) \\ &= \lim_{n\to\infty} \mu(A_n).\end{aligned}$$

□

Proposition 9 (**Continuity From Above**). Given $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty} \in \mathcal{E}$ such that $A_{n+1} \subset A_n$ for every $n \geq 1$ (A_n is decreasing). If $\mu(A_1) < \infty$, denote $\lim_n A_n = A$, then

$$\mu\left(\bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \lim_{n\to\infty} \mu(A_n) = \mu(A).$$

Proof. Set $B_n = A_1 \backslash A_n$, then we know that the sequence $\{B_n, n \geq 1\}$ is increasing, then we have

$$\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} B_n = A_1 \backslash \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n,$$

thus,

$$\mu\left(A_1 \backslash \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} B_n\right) = \lim_{n\to\infty} \mu(B_n) = \lim_{n\to\infty} \mu(A \backslash A_n).$$

Given that the measure of A_n is always finite, so $\mu(A_1 \backslash A_n) = \mu(A_1) - \mu(A_n)$ and

$$\mu\left(A_1 \backslash \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \mu(A_1) - \mu\left(\bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right),$$

we then have

$$\mu(A_1) - \mu\left(\bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \lim_{n\to\infty} \left(\mu(A_1) - \mu(A_n)\right),$$

which is

$$\mu\left(\bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \lim_{n\to\infty} \mu(A_n).$$

□

Definition 12 (**Finite, σ-finite, Σ-finite measures**)**.** Let μ be a measure on $(E, \mathcal{E})$. μ is said to be:

- **Finite**: If $\mu(E) < \infty$;
- **σ-finite**: If there exists a countable partition $\{E_n\}_I$ of E such that $\mu(E_n) < \infty$ for all $n \in I$;
- **Σ-finite**: If there exists a sequence of measures $\{\mu_n\}$ such that μ_n is finite for all n and $\mu = \sum_n \mu_n$.

Proposition 10. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measure space. Then

$$\mu \text{ is finite} \implies \mu \text{ is } \sigma\text{-finite} \implies \mu \text{ is } \Sigma\text{-finite}.$$

Proof. μ finite $\implies$ μ σ-finite is trivial. Now suppose μ is σ-finite with partition $\{E_n\}$ such that $\mu(E_n) < \infty, \forall n$. Define a sequence of measures μ_n by $\mu_n(B) = \mu(E_n \cap B), \forall B \in \mathcal{E}$. Then by monotonicity, $\mu(E_n \cap B) < \mu(E_n) < \infty$, and

$$\sum_n \mu_n = \sum_n \mu(E_n \cap B) := \mu\left(\bigcup_n E_n \cap B\right) = \mu(E \cap B) = \mu(B).$$

□

Given a measurable space $(E, \mathcal{E})$, we are able to define many different measures. How can we tell them apart?

Theorem 4 (**Monotone class theorem for measures**)**.** Let $(E, \mathcal{E})$ be a measurable space, where 2 finite measures μ, ν are defined. If μ and ν agree on a p-system generating $\mathcal{E}$, then $\mu \equiv \nu$.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a p-system generating $\mathcal{E}$, (i.e, $\mathcal{E} = \sigma(\mathcal{C})$). We assume $\mu(A) = \nu(A), \forall A \in \mathcal{C}$ and both μ, ν are finite. Then we will show $\mu(A) = \nu(A)$ extend to all $A \in \mathcal{E}$. This is equivalent as showing

$$\mathcal{D} = \{A \in \mathcal{E} : \mu(A) = \nu(A)\} \supset \mathcal{E}.$$

Since $\mathcal{D} \supset \mathcal{E} \supset \mathcal{C}$, it is enough to show $\mathcal{D}$ is a d-system (by Monotone class theorem 1). First it is obvious that $E \in \mathcal{D}, \mu(E) = \nu(E) < \infty$. Let $A, B \in \mathcal{D}, A \supset B$, then

$$\mu(A \setminus B) = \mu(A) - \mu(B) = \nu(A) - \nu(B) = \nu(A \setminus B),$$

hence $A \setminus B \subset \mathcal{D}$. Finally let $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty} \subset \mathcal{D}$, $A_n \nearrow A$, then using the continuity of μ, ν, we can easily show that $\mu(A) = \nu(A)$. Hence $\mathcal{D}$ is a d-system. □

Corollary 1. Let μ, ν be probability measures on $(\overline{\mathbb{R}}, \mathfrak{B}(\overline{\mathbb{R}}))$, then $\nu = \mu$ if and only if $\mu([-\infty, r]) = \nu([-\infty, r])$ for every $r \in \mathbb{R}$.

This later on illustrates that the cumulative distribution function (CDF) for a random variable is unique.

Definition 13. Let μ be a measure on $(E, \mathcal{E})$, a singleton x is said to be an **atom** of μ if $\mu\{x\} > 0$. The measure μ is said to be **diffuse** if it has no atoms. Furthermore, μ is said to be **purely atomic** if the set of its atoms D is countable and $\mu(E \setminus D) = 0$.

Proposition 11. Let μ be a Σ-finite measure on $(E, \mathcal{E})$, then μ admits a unique decomposition $\mu = \lambda + \nu$ where λ is diffuse and ν is purely atomic.

Definition 14. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measure space. A measurable set $B \in E$ is said to be **negligible** if $\mu(B) = 0$. Any subset $F \subset B$ (not necessarily measurable) is also said to be negligible. The measurable space is said to be **complete** if every negligible set is measurable.

If a property holds for all but a negligible set in E, we would say it holds for almost every x (or almost everywhere). We will very commonly use the notation "almost everywhere", and **a.e** in short. If a measurable space is not complete, we may extend μ onto an enlarged $\mathcal{E}$, then the new measure space $(E, \bar{\mathcal{E}}, \bar{\mu})$ is called the **completion** of $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$.

Theorem 5 (Carathéodory's extension theorem). Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measurable space, $\mathcal{F}$ be the collection of all negligible sets of E. Let $\bar{\mathcal{E}}$ be the σ-algebra generated by $\mathcal{E} \cup \mathcal{F}$, then $\forall B \in \bar{\mathcal{E}}$, $B = A \cup F$ where $A \in \mathcal{E}, F \in \mathcal{F}$; Furthermore $\bar{\mu}(A \cup F) = \mu(A)$ defines a unique measure $\bar{\mu}$ on $\bar{\mathcal{E}}$, $\bar{\mu}(A) = \mu(A), \forall A \in \mathcal{E}$, and $(E, \bar{\mathcal{E}}, \bar{\mu})$ is complete.

In this sense, the Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{R}$ can be extended to $\mathfrak{B}(\bar{\mathbb{R}})$.

1.5 Integration

1.5.1 Construction of integral

Given a measure space $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$, we like to define the integral of a function f over E with respect to the measure μ. We shall denote this as

$$\mu(f) = \int_E f d\mu = \int_E \mu(dx) f(x).$$

Recall that any measurable function can be approximated by a sequence of simple functions. We hence first define the integral for simple functions:

Definition 15. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measure space. f be a simple function with its canonical form $f = \sum_{i=1}^n a_i \mathbb{1}_{A_i}$ $(A_i \cap A_j = \varnothing, i \neq j))$, then the integral of f over E is

$$\mu(f) = \int_E \sum_{i=1}^n a_i \mathbb{1}_{A_i} d\mu = \sum_{i=1}^n a_i \mu(A_i).$$

Proposition 12. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measure space, $a, b \in \mathbb{R}^+$. Let f, g be positive simple functions, denote $\mu(f)$ as the integral of f with respect to μ, then the following properties of integrals hold.

- **Linearity**: $\mu(af + bg) = a\mu(f) + b\mu(g)$;
- **Non-negativity**: $\mu(f) \geq 0$ and $\mu(f) = 0$ if and only if $f \equiv 0$;
- **Monotoncity**: If $f \leq g$, then $\mu(f) \leq \mu(g)$.

Proof. Let us suppose $f = \sum_{i=1}^n a_i \mathbb{1}_{A_i}$ and $g = \sum_{j=1}^m b_i \mathbb{1}_{B_j}$. W.L.O.G, assume $\{A_i\}$s and $\{B_j\}$s are disjoint and $\bigcup_i A_i = \bigcup_j B_j$ (otherwise we can always rearrange the partition). Then define $C_{ij} = A_i \cap B_j$, then we have

$$f = \sum_{j=1}^m \sum_{i=1}^n a_i \mathbb{1}_{A_i \cap B_j}, \quad g = \sum_{j=1}^m \sum_{i=1}^n b_j \mathbb{1}_{B_j \cap A_i}.$$

Hence

$$\begin{aligned}\mu(f+g) &= \sum_{i=1}^{n}\sum_{j=1}^{m}(a_i+b_j)\mu(A_i\cap B_j)\\ &= \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i \mathbb{1}_{A_i} + \sum_{j=1}^{m} b_i \mu(B_j)\\ &= \mu(f)+\mu(g).\end{aligned}$$

Therefore the result holds trivially for $af+bg$ since one can let $a_i' \equiv a\cdot a_i, b_j' \equiv b\cdot b_j$. The non-negativity result is trivial, since

$$\mu(f) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i\mu(A_i) \geq 0, \quad \mu(A_i)\geq 0, a_i \geq 0.$$

Then for monotonicity, simply let $h = g - f$, then $h \geq 0$ and is also simple, where we may use the result from non-negativity. □

In fact, by using the simple function approximation, we can extend the above results to a more general class of functions. Recall that if $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$, then $f = \lim_{n\to\infty} d_n \circ f$, where $d_n \circ f$ is positive, simple, and

$$d_n(x) := \sum_{k=1}^{n2^n} \frac{k-1}{2^n}\cdot \mathbb{1}_{\left[\frac{k-1}{2^n},\frac{k}{2^n}\right)}(x) + n\cdot \mathbb{1}_{[n,\infty]}(x),$$

Theorem 6. Suppose $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$, if $\{f_n\}$ is a sequence of positive increasing simple functions with $f_n \nearrow f$ (pointwise), then

$$\lim_{n\to\infty}\int f_n d\mu = \int f d\mu.$$

The proof of this theorem is omitted.

For general f, we may use the fact that $f = f^+ - f^-$, and hence

$$\mu(f) = \mu(f^+) - \mu(f^-),$$

provided that at least one of $\mu(f^+), \mu(f^-)$ is finite.

Proposition 13. Let $f, g \in \mathcal{E}_+$, then the following hold.

- $\mu(f)\geq 0$, and $\mu(f) = 0$ if and only if $f \equiv 0$ (μ-a.e);
- $\mu(af+bg) = a\mu(f) + b\mu(g)$, provided $a, b \in \mathbb{R}^+$;
- If $f \leq g$, then $\mu(f)\leq \mu(g)$ (μ-a.e).

Proof. By definition it is clear that $\mu(f)\geq 0$. Also $f\equiv 0$ trivially implies $\mu(f) = 0$. Assume $\mu(f) = 0$, and let $A = \{x\in E : f(x) > 0\}$ with $\mu(A) = \delta > 0$. For each $n\in\mathbb{N}$, let $A_n := \{x\in E : f(x)\geq \frac{1}{n}\}$. Clearly $A_n \nearrow A$, by monotonicity of μ,

$$\lim_{n\to\infty}\mu\left(\bigcup_{i=1}^{n} A_n\right) = \mu(A) := \delta > 0.$$

Since $A_n \nearrow A$, there exists $N \in \mathbb{N}$ large enough such that $\mu(A_N) = \frac{\delta}{2}$. In this case

$$\int f d\mu \geq \int f \mathbb{1}_{A_N} d\mu \geq \frac{1}{N} \mu(A_N) > 0,$$

which is a contradiction. Hence $\mu(f) = 0$ for μ-a.e.

For linearity, simply consider the limit of simple functions and apply monotone convergence theorem (which we will see later).

Consider $f_n = d_n \circ f$, $g_n = d_n \circ g$, then $f_n \leq g_n$, and since they are simple, $\mu(f_n) \leq \mu(g_n)$ for all n, and the desired result will hold by taking the limit. □

Definition 16. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measure space, a function $f \in \mathcal{E}$ is said to be (μ-)**integrable** if $\mu(f)$ exists and is finite. Let $A \in \mathcal{E}$, the **integral of f over A**, denote as $\mu(f\mathbb{1}_A)$, is given by

$$\mu(f\mathbb{1}_A) = \int_A f d\mu.$$

We now define the **Lebesgue integral**:

Definition 17 (**Lebesgue integral**)**.** Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \text{Leb})$ be a measure space with Lebesgue measure $\text{Leb}(\cdot)$. For a positive function $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$, the Lebesgue integral of f is defined as

$$\text{Leb}(f) := \int f d\mu = \sup_{g \leq f} \int g d\mu = \sup_{g \leq f} \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i \mu(A_i).$$

where $g \geq 0$ and $g = \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i \mathbb{1}_{A_i}$ is simple.

Recall that previously, for a positive function f, we approximate it by $f = \lim_{n\to\infty} f_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} d_n \circ f$ where hence based on this approximation we may also define the Lebesgue integral of f as

$$\text{Leb}(f) := \int f d\mu = \lim_{n\to\infty} \int d_n \circ f d\mu.$$

Proposition 14. Let $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$, and $g \geq 0$ be simple, then

$$\sup_{g \leq f} \int g d\mu = \lim_{n\to\infty} \int d_n \circ f d\mu.$$

Proof. By Definition 17, and the fact that $d_n \circ f \nearrow f$, and each $d_n \circ f$ is simple, we have

$$\sup_{g \leq f} \int g d\mu \geq \int d_n \circ f d\mu, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N},$$

so the inequality is also true if we take the limit of the right hand side. It remains to show the other side of the inequality. Note that

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{n\to\infty} (\mu(d_n \circ f) - \mu(g)) &= \lim_{n\to\infty} (\mu(d_n \circ f) - \mu(d_n \circ g)) \\ &= \lim_{n\to\infty} \mu(d_n \circ (f - g)) \\ &\geq 0, \end{aligned}$$

as desired. □

Lemma 3. Let $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$, and $A_1, A_2, \cdots \in \mathcal{E}$ are disjoint. Denote $A = \bigcup_i A_i$, Then

$$\mu(f\mathbb{1}_A) = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \mu(f\mathbb{1}_{A_i}).$$

Lemma 4. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measure space. For a fixed function $f : E \to \mathbb{R}^+$, and any set $A \in \mathcal{E}$,

$$\nu(A) := \int_A f d\mu$$

is a measure on $(E, \mathcal{E})$.

Theorem 7. Let $(E, \mathcal{E})$ be a measurable space, $L : \mathcal{E}_+ \to \overline{\mathbb{R}}_+$ be a mapping, then there exists a unique measure μ on $(E, \mathcal{E})$ such that $\mu(f) = L(f)$ for all $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$ if and only if

- $L(0) = 0$;
- $L(af + bg) = aL(f) + bL(g), \forall f, g \in \mathcal{E}_+, a, b \in \mathbb{R}_+$;
- If $f_n \nearrow f$, $\{f_n\} \subset \mathcal{E}_+$, then $L(f_n) \nearrow f$.

Proof. Suppose such μ exists and $\mu(f) = L(f)$, then by using the properties of integral, the properties on L can be easily verified. Instead suppose L satisfies the above three properties. Define μ by

$$\mu(A) = L(\mathbb{1}_A),$$

then $\mu(\varnothing) = L(\mathbb{1}_\varnothing) = L(0) = 0$, and for $\{A_n\} \subset \mathcal{E}$ disjoint,

$$\mu\left(\bigcup_n A_n\right) = L(\mathbb{1}_{\bigcup A_n}) = L\left(\sum_n \mathbb{1}_{A_n}\right) = \sum_n L(\mathbb{1}_{A_n}) = \sum_n \mu(A_n),$$

hence we claim that μ is a measure on $(E, \mathcal{E})$. By linearity of L, we have that for any simple function $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$, $\mu(f) = L(f)$, and hence for any $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$, $\mu(f) = L(f)$. This is because we can find a sequence of simple functions $\{f_n\}$ and that $f_n \nearrow f$, and apply monotone convergence theorem. The uniqueness directly comes from the definition that $\mu(A) = L(\mathbb{1}_A)$ for all $A \in \mathcal{E}$. □

1.5.2 Convergence Theorems

Theorem 8 (**Monotone convergence theorem (Beppo Levi theorem)**). Let $\{f_n\} \in \mathcal{E}_+$ be increasing, then $f := \lim_{n\to\infty} f_n$ exists (possibly infinite), and

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \int f d\mu = \int \lim_{n\to\infty} f_n d\mu = \int f d\mu.$$

Proof. Since $f_n \nearrow f$, by monotonicity of integral it is clear that

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \int f_n d\mu \le \int f d\mu,$$

hence it suffices to show the reverse inequality. Now for each $n \ge 1$, define $\{\phi_{n,k} : k \ge 1\}$ to be a sequence of simple functions such that $\phi_{n,k} \nearrow_{k\to\infty} f_n$. Define

$$g_k := \max\{\phi_{1,k}, \phi_{2,k}, \cdots, \phi_{k,k}\}.$$

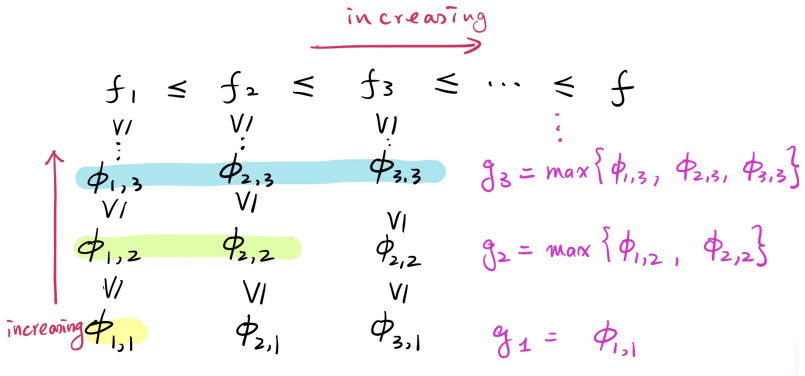


Figure 2: Graphical illustration of $\phi_{n,k}$ and g_n.

It is easy to see that g_k is also simple and increasing, and furthermore $g_k \le f$, $\forall k$. Hence by taking the limit, $\lim_{k\to\infty} g_k \le f$. On the other hand,

$$\lim_{k\to\infty} g_k \ge \lim_{k\to\infty} \phi_{n,k} = f_n \implies \lim_{k\to\infty} g_k \ge \lim_{n,k\to\infty} \phi_{n,k} = f,$$

hence $\lim_{k\to\infty} g_k = f$, which means f is the limit of the increasing sequence of simple functions g_k, hence

$$\int f d\mu = \lim_{k\to\infty} \int g_k d\mu.$$

Finally according to our construction, $\phi_{1,k}, \phi_{2,k}, \cdots, \le f_k$, i.e., $g_k \le f_k$, hence by monotonicity of μ, $\mu(g_k) \le \mu(f_k)$, $\forall k$. Hence by taking the limit,

$$\int f d\mu := \lim_{k\to\infty} \int g_k d\mu \le \lim_{k\to\infty} \int f_k d\mu.$$

□

Proposition 15 (**Fatou's lemma**)**.** Let $\{f_n\} \subset \mathcal{E}_+$, then

$$\int \liminf_n f_n d\mu \le \liminf_n \int f_n d\mu.$$

Note that we do not require f_n to be increasing!

Proof. In order to apply monotone convergence theorem, we can construct a sequence of increasing functions out of f_n. Let

$$g_n := \inf_{m\ge n} f_m,$$

then g_n is increasing and positive. Hence

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \int g_n d\mu = \int \lim_{n\to\infty} g_n d\mu.$$

Recall the definition of g, for any $m \ge n$, $f_m \ge g_n$. Hence by linearity of μ we have

$$\int f_m d\mu \ge \int g_n d\mu, \quad \forall m \ge n,$$

i.e.,

$$\int g_n d\mu \leq \inf_{m \geq n} \int f_m d\mu.$$

By taking the limit, as $n \to \infty$, we have

$$\int g_n d\mu := \int \liminf_n f_n d\mu \leq \liminf_n \int f_n d\mu.$$

□

Proposition 16. [Reverse Fatou] Let $\{f_n\}$ be a sequence of measurable functions, and let $\mu(g) < \infty$.

- If $f_n \leq g$ for all n, then
$$\mu(\limsup_n f_n) \geq \limsup_n \mu(f_n);$$
- If $f_n \geq -g$ for all n, then
$$\mu(\liminf_n f_n) \leq \liminf_n \mu(f_n).$$

Proof. If $f_n \leq g$, then $g - f_n \geq 0$. By Fatou's lemma and linearity,

$$\mu g - \mu \limsup_n f_n = \mu(\liminf_n (g - f_n)) \leq \liminf_n \mu(g - f_n) = \mu g - \limsup_n \mu(f_n),$$

which is because $\liminf(g - f_n) = -\limsup -(g - f_n) = g - \limsup f_n$. Hence

$$\mu(\limsup_n f_n) \geq \limsup_n \mu(f_n).$$

The other inequality is similar: If $f_n \geq -g$, then $f_n + g \geq 0$, by Fatou's lemma

$$\mu g + \mu \liminf_n f_n = \mu(\liminf_n (f_n + g)) \leq \liminf_n \mu(g + f_n) = \mu g + \liminf \mu f_n,$$

hence

$$\mu(\liminf_n f_n) \leq \liminf_n \mu(f_n).$$

□

Theorem 9 (Dominated convergence theorem)**.** Let $\{f_n\}$ be a sequence of measurable functions such that $f_n \to f$, and $|f_n| \leq g, \forall n$ for some measurable g and $\mu(g) < \infty$. Then $\lim_n \mu(f_n) = \mu(\lim_n f_n)$.

Proof. Since $-g < f_n < g$, by Proposition 16, we already have

$$\mu(\limsup_n f_n) \geq \limsup_n \mu(f_n), \quad \mu(\liminf_n f_n) \leq \liminf_n \mu(f_n).$$

Since $f_n \to f$, i.e, the limit exists, so $\liminf_n f_n = \limsup_n f_n$, and furthermore

$$\mu(\underbrace{\liminf_n f_n}_{f}) \leq \liminf_n \mu(f_n) \leq \limsup_n \mu(f_n) \leq \mu(\underbrace{\limsup_n f_n}_{f}),$$

hence

$$\liminf_n \mu(f_n) = \limsup_n \mu(f_n),$$

and so

$$\mu \lim_n f_n = \lim_n \mu(f_n).$$

□

An application of dominated convergence theorem is interchanging integrals and derivatives. Define

$$g(\theta) = \int f(x,\theta)\mu(dx),$$

then by definition,

$$g'(\theta) = \frac{d}{d\theta}\int f(x,\theta)\mu(dx),$$

and the question is: Can we perform

$$\frac{d}{d\theta}\int f(x,\theta)\mu(dx) \stackrel{?}{=} \int \frac{d}{d\theta} f(x,\theta)\mu(dx).$$

Proposition 17 (Leibniz integral rule). Let $g(\theta)$ be defined as above. For a fixed $\theta_0 \in \mathbb{R}$ and a neighborhood $\theta_0 \in U$. Suppose there exists an integrable function $h : E \to \mathbb{R}$ and for μ-a.e $x \in U$, $\frac{\partial f(x,\theta)}{\partial \theta}$ exists and $|\frac{\partial f(x,\theta)}{\partial \theta}| \leq h(x)$, then $g'(\theta)$ exists in U and

$$g'(\theta) = \int \frac{\partial}{\partial \theta} f(x,\theta)\mu(dx).$$

This is a simple application of dominated convergence theorem.

1.6 Radon-Nikodym theorem

Let $(E,\mathcal{E}), (F,\mathcal{F})$ be two measurable spaces, and define a measurable function $h : F \to E$. Furthermore let ν be a measure on $(F,\mathcal{F})$, we may define the **pushforward measure** by $\nu \circ h^{-1}$, where $\nu \circ h^{-1}$ is a measure on $(E,\mathcal{E})$, and for all $A \in \mathcal{E}$,

$$\nu \circ h^{-1}(A) = \nu(h^{-1}(A)). \tag{1.1}$$

Proposition 18. $v \circ h^{-1}$ is a measure on $(E,\mathcal{E})$.

Proof. Since $h : F \to E$ is measurable, hence $h^{-1}(\varnothing) = \varnothing$, hence $\nu \circ h^{-1}(\varnothing) = 0$. By non-negativity of ν, $\nu \circ h^{-1}(A) \geq 0$ for all $A \in \mathcal{E}$. Let $\{A_n\} \subset \mathcal{E}$ be disjoint, then using the measurability of h,

$$(\nu \circ h)^{-1}\left(\bigcup_n A_n\right) = \nu \circ \bigcup_n h^{-1}(A_n) = \sum_n \nu \circ h^{-1}(A_n),$$

since $h^{-1}(A_n)$'s are disjoint. □

Given the new measure $\nu \circ h^{-1}$, we are interested in the integral with respect to this measure.

Theorem 10. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}), (F, \mathcal{F})$ be measurable spaces and $h : F \to E$ be measurable. Then for every $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$,

$$\int f(x)(\nu \circ h^{-1})(dx) = \int f(h(y))\nu(dy).$$

Proof. By Theorem 7, we let $L(f) := \nu(f \circ h)$, then clearly $L(0) = 0$, $L(af + bg) = aL(f) + bL(g)$, and $L(f_n) \nearrow L(f)$ of $f_n \nearrow f$, $f_n \in \mathcal{E}_+$ by monotone convergence theorem. Hence there exists a unique measure μ on $(E, \mathcal{E})$ such that $L(f) = \mu(f)$. We claim that this μ is exactly $\nu \circ h^{-1}$, since $\forall A \in \mathcal{E}$,

$$L(\mathbb{1}_A) = \mu(A) = \nu(\mathbb{1}_A \circ h) = \nu(h^{-1}(A)).$$

□

Corollary 2 (Change of variable formula). Let $E = F = \mathbb{R}$, and ν denote the Lebesgue measure, h is a real-valued, strictly increasing function which is continuously differentiable with continuously differentiable inverse, then

$$\int f(y)\frac{dh^{-1}}{dy}dx = \int f(h(y))dy.$$

Proof. Let λ denote the Lebesgue measure, then

$$\int f(h(y))dy = \int f(h(y))\lambda(dy) = \int f(x)(\lambda \circ h^{-1})(dx), \quad \nu = \lambda \circ h^{-1}.$$

Let $L(f) = \int f(y)\frac{dh^{-1}}{dy}(y)dy$, we can verify the properties on L based on Theorem 7, hence $L(f) = \mu(f)$ for a unique measure μ, and for an interval $[a, b]$,

$$\mu[a, b] = L(\mathbb{1}_{[a,b]}) = \int_a^b \frac{dh^{-1}}{dy}(y)dy = h^{-1}(b) - h^{-1}(a),$$

and

$$\nu[a, b] = (\lambda \circ h^{-1})[a, b] = \lambda(h^{-1}[a, b]) = h^{-1}(b) - h^{-1}(a).$$

We hence conclude $\mu \equiv \nu$, since intervals are a p-system generating $\mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R})$, and monotone class theorem follows. □

In fact, any measure in a standard measure space can be written as a transformation of the Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{R}_+$.

Definition 18. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measure space, $p(x) \in \mathcal{E}_+$, define

$$\nu(A) = \int_A p(x)\mu(dx),$$

we say μ is a measure referred to the indefinite integral of p with respect to μ.

It is easy to verify that $\nu(A)$ is a measure, since

$$\nu(\varnothing) = \int \mathbb{1}_\varnothing(x)p(x)\mu(dx) = 0,$$

and if we let $\{A_n\} \subset \mathcal{E}$ be disjoint, then

$$\nu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \int_{\bigcup A_n} p(x)\mu(dx) = \int \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mathbb{1}_{A_i}p(x)\mu(dx),$$

and by applying monotone convergence theorem, one will get the desired result.

Proposition 19. Let ν be defined as in Definition 18, then for all $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$, $\nu(f) = \mu(pf)$.

Proof. Let $L(f) = \mu(pf)$, it is easy to verify that the conditions for Theorem 7 hold. So there exists a unique measure $\widetilde{\mu}$ such that $L(f) = \widetilde{\mu} f$. Then $\nu(A) = L(\mathbb{1}_A) = \widetilde{A}$, and hence $\nu f = \widetilde{\mu} f = L(f)$. □

Definition 19. Let μ, ν be two measures on $(E, \mathcal{E})$. We say ν is **absolutely continuous** with respect to μ (μ dominates ν), if $\mu(A) = 0$ implies $\nu(A) = 0$, for all $A \in \mathcal{E}$.

Theorem 11 (Radon-Nikodym). Let μ, ν be two measures on $(E, \mathcal{E})$ and assume μ is σ-finite, ν is absolutely continuous with respect to μ, then there exists a unique $p \in \mathcal{E}_+$ (up to almost everywhere equivalence), such that for all $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$,

$$\nu(f) = \mu(pf), \text{ i.e} \int f(x)\nu(dx) = \int p(x)f(x)\mu(dx).$$

We also denote $p = \frac{d\nu}{d\mu}$, as the **Radon-Nikodym** derivative of ν with respect to μ.

The proof of this theorem is rather technical, hence we shall omit. A nice reference can be found in Axler [1] (Theorem 9.36).

1.7 Kernels

Definition 20. Given two measurable spaces $(E, \mathcal{E}), (F, \mathcal{F})$, a mapping $K : E \times \mathcal{F} \to \overline{\mathbb{R}}_+$ is called a **transition kernel** (or simply kernel) from $(E, \mathcal{E})$ into $(F, \mathcal{F})$, if

- The mapping $x \mapsto K(x, B)$ is $\mathcal{E}$-measurable for all $B \in \mathcal{F}$;
- The mapping $B \mapsto K(x, B)$ is a measure on $(F, \mathcal{F})$ for all $x \in E$. We have

$$K(x, B) = \int K(x, dy)\mathbb{1}_B.$$

We sometimes denote $\mu_x(B) := K(x, B)$ as the measure on $(F, \mathcal{F})$ depending on x. Then since $K(x, B)$ is a measure on $(F, \mathcal{F})$, we may define the integral of $f \in \mathcal{F}_+$ with respect to K as Kf, or $\mu_x(f)$.

Proposition 20. Given a measurable function $f \in \mathcal{F}_+$, and a transition kernel K from $(E, \mathcal{E})$ into $(F, \mathcal{F})$, then

$$Kf(x) := \mu_x(f)(x) = \int_F f(y)\mu_x(dy) = \int_F K(x, dy)f(y)$$

is $\mathcal{E}_+$ measurable.

Proof. Since $f \in \mathcal{F}_+$ is measurable, then we can find a sequence of positive simple functions $\{f_n\} \subset \mathcal{F}_+$ such that $f_n \nearrow f$. Then

$$\int_F K(x, dy)f(y) = \int_F \lim_{n\to\infty} K(x, dy) \cdot f_n(y) = \lim_{n\to\infty} \int_F K(x, dy) \cdot f_n(y),$$

by monotone convergence theorem. Write $f_n(y) = \sum_{i=1} a_{n_i} \mathbb{1}_{A_{n_i}}$, then by linearity of integral over finite sum, we have

$$\int_F K(x, dy)f(y) = \lim_{n\to\infty} \sum_{i=1}^{n_i} a_{n_i} \int_F K(x, dy) \cdot \mathbb{1}_{A_{n_i}} := \lim_{n\to\infty} a_{n_i} K(x, A_{n_i}).$$

Since K is a kernel, so for each fixed A_{n_i}, the map $x \mapsto K(x, A_{n_i})$ is $\mathcal{E}_+$-measurable, hence so is its limit. □

Proposition 21. Given a transition kernel K from $(E, \mathcal{E})$ into $(F, \mathcal{F})$, then for every measure μ on $(E, \mathcal{E})$ and any $B \in \mathcal{F}$,

$$\mu K(B) := \int_E \mu(dx) K(x, B)$$

defines a measure μK on $(F, \mathcal{F})$.

Proof. Note that for a fixed x, $K(x, B)$ is a measure on $(F, \mathcal{F})$, so $K(x, \varnothing) = 0$, and $K(x, B) \geq 0$ for all $B \in \mathcal{F}$. Hence

$$\mu K(\varnothing) = \int \mu(dx) \cdot 0 \equiv 0,$$

and $\mu K(B) \geq 0$ by non-negativity of measures. Let $\{B_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$ be a sequence of disjoint sets in $\mathcal{F}$, then since $K(x, B)$ is a measure, we have that

$$\mu K\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} B_n\right) = \int \mu(dx) \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} K(x, B_n).$$

Let $f_n = \sum_{i=1}^{n} K(x, B_i)$, by non-negativity of K, f_n is positive, and furthermore $f_n \nearrow f := \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} K(x, B_n)$. So by monotone convergence theorem,

$$\int \mu(dx) \cdot \lim_{n\to\infty} \sum_{i=1}^{n} K(x, B_i) = \lim_{n\to\infty} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \int \mu(dx) K(x, B_i) \equiv \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \int \mu(dx) K(x, B_n).$$

Hence $K(x, B)$ is a measure on $(F, \mathcal{F})$. □

For any $f \in \mathcal{F}_+$, in fact

$$\mu K(f) = \mu(Kf) = \int \mu(dx) K(x, dy) f(y) = \int_E \mu(dx) \int_F K(x, dy) f(y).$$

The composition of kernels is again a kernel.

Proposition 22. Let K be a kernel from E to F, L be a kernel from F to G, then KL is a kernel from E to G defined by

$$KL(x, B) = \int K(x, dy) L(y, B), \quad \forall x \in E, B \in \mathcal{G}.$$

Proof. It suffices to verify that $x \mapsto KL(x, B)$ is $\mathcal{E}_+$ measurable and $B \mapsto KL(x, B)$ is a measure on $(G, \mathcal{G})$. The proofs for those two cases are almost identical to Proposition 20 and 21. □

Definition 21. Let K be a (transition) kernel from E to F. Then

- K is a **probability kernel** if $\forall x \in E$, $K(x, F) = 1$;
- K is **finite**, if $K(x, F) < \infty, \forall x \in E$;
- K is **bounded**, if $\sup_{x\in E} K(x, F) < \infty$;
- K is **σ-finite**, if the measure $B \mapsto K(x, B)$ is σ-finite;

- K is **σ-bounded**, if there exists a partition of F, denote as $\{F_n\}$ such that $\sup_{x\in E} K(x, F_n) < \infty, \forall n$;
- K is **Σ-finite**, if $K = \sum_n K_n$ for some finite kernels K_n;
- K is **Σ-bounded**, if $K = \sum_n K_n$ for some bounded kernels K_n.

Example 4. The kernels can be used to define conditional distribution. Suppose $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, \mathbb{P})$ is the probability space, and let $X : \Omega \to E, Y : \Omega \to F$ be two random variables. We are interested in the conditional distribution of Y given X. In fact, if we define

$$K(x, B) = \mathbb{P}(Y \in B | X = x),$$

where $x \in E, B \in \mathcal{F}$, then K is indeed a kernel from E to F. Define a measure μ on $(E, \mathcal{E})$ as

$$\mu(A) = \mathbb{P}(X \in A), \forall A \in \mathcal{E},$$

then using Proposition 21, we have for all $B \in \mathcal{F}$,

$$\mu K(B) = \int_E \mu(dx) K(x, B) = \int_E \mathbb{P}(dx)\mathbb{P}(Y \in B | X = x) \equiv \mathbb{P}(Y \in B).$$

So μK can be viewed as the marginal distribution of Y. Furthermore, for all $\mathcal{F}_+$ measurable functions f,

$$Kf(x) := \int K(x, dy) f(y) = \int \mathbb{P}_{Y|X=x}(dy) f(y) \equiv \mathbb{E}[f(Y)|X = x],$$

the conditional expectation of $f(Y)$ given $X = x$. Finally, we already know that μK is the marginal density of Y, so

$$(\mu K) f := \int f(y) \mathbb{P}_Y(dy) = \mathbb{E}[f(Y)],$$

on the other hand,

$$\mu(Kf) = \int \mu(dx) Kf(x) = \int \mathbb{P}_X(dx) \mathbb{E}[f(Y)|X = x] = \mathbb{E}_X[\mathbb{E}[f(Y)|X]] \equiv \mathbb{E}[f(Y)].$$

Hence we have $\mu(Kf) = (\mu K) f$, and the latter is also known as the law of total expectation.

1.8 Product spaces

Definition 22. Let $(E, \mathcal{E}), (F, \mathcal{F})$ be measurable spaces, $A \subset E, B \subset F$, we write

$$A \times B := \{(x, y) | x \in A, y \in B\},$$

and $A \times B$ is called the **product** of A and B. If $A \in \mathcal{E}, B \in \mathcal{F}$, $A \times B$ is called a **measurable rectangle**, and we define a **product σ-algebra** on $E \times F$ by $\mathcal{E} \otimes F$, such that

$$\mathcal{E} \otimes F := \sigma\{\text{collection of all measurable rectangles on } E \times F\}.$$

The measurable space $(E \times F, \mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{F})$ is called the product space of $(E, \mathcal{E})$ and $(F, \mathcal{F})$. Now suppose we have a function $f(x, y) : E \times F \to \mathbb{R}_+$, we say f is $(\mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{F})$ measurable if $f^{-1}(B) \in \mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{F}$, for any $B \in \mathfrak{B}(\overline{\mathbb{R}})$. If f is $\mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{F}$ measurable, then $x \mapsto f(x, y)$ is measurable in $(E, \mathcal{E})$, and $y \mapsto f(x, y)$ is measurable in $(F, \mathcal{F})$ (the converse is not true in general).

Theorem 12 (Fubini's). Let μ, ν be Σ-finite measures on $(E, \mathcal{E}), (F, \mathcal{F})$, respectively. Then there exists a unique Σ-finite measure π on $(E \times F, \mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{F})$ such that for every $f \in \mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{F}$,

$$\pi f = \int_E \mu(dx) \int_F \nu(dy) f(x, y) = \int_F \nu(dy) \int_E \mu(dx) f(x, y).$$

If f is π-integrable, then $y \mapsto f(x, y)$ is ν-integrable for almost every x, and $x \mapsto f(x, y)$ is μ-integrable for almost every y.

2 Probability Spaces

2.1 Basics of probability spaces

Definition 23. A probability space is defined as $(\Omega, \mathcal{H}, \mathbb{P})$, where Ω is the **sample space**, where elements $\omega \in \Omega$ are called **outcomes**, the σ-algebra of Ω, denote as $\mathcal{H}$, where elements inside $\mathcal{H}$ are called **events**. $\mathbb{P}$ is the probability measure defined on $(\Omega, \mathcal{H})$.

Since $\mathbb{P}$ is a measure, hence $\mathbb{P}$ naturally satisfies all the properties of a measure. More importantly, a probability measure on $(\Omega, \mathcal{H})$ satisfies $\mathbb{P}(\Omega) = 1$.

Proposition 23. Let $(\Omega, \mathcal{H}, \mathbb{P})$ be a probability space, then

- $\mathbb{P}(\Omega) = 1$, and $\mathbb{P}(\varnothing) = 0$;
- **Monotonicity**: If $A \subset B \subset \mathcal{H}$, then $0 \leq \mathbb{P}(A) \leq \mathbb{P}(B)$;
- **Countable additivity**: If $\{A_n\} \subset \mathcal{H}$ are disjoint, then $\mathbb{P}\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mathbb{P}(A_n)$;
- **Countable sub-additivity**: If $\{A_n\} \subset \mathcal{H}$, then $\mathbb{P}\left(\bigcup_{n} A_n\right) \leq \sum_{n} \mathbb{P}(A_n)$;
- **Continuity from below**: If $\{A_n\} \subset \mathcal{H}$ and $A_n \nearrow A$, then $\mathbb{P}(A_n) \nearrow \mathbb{P}(A)$;
- **Continuity from above**: If $\{A_n\} \subset \mathcal{H}$ and $A_n \searrow \mathbb{P}(A)$, then $\mathbb{P}(A_n) \searrow \mathbb{P}(A)$.

If an event $H \in \mathcal{H}$ has probability one, we say H happens almost surely. If a statement holds for almost every $w \in \Omega$ except on a set of probability measure zero, we say the statement holds almost surely (or almost everywhere).

Definition 24 (Random variable). Let $(\Omega, \mathcal{H})$, $(E, \mathcal{E})$ be measurable spaces, a random variable is a mapping $X : \Omega \to E$, such that $\forall A \in \mathcal{E}$,

$$X^{-1}(A) := \{\omega \in \Omega : X(\omega) \in A\} \in \mathcal{H}.$$

By monotone class theorem, it suffices to check if $X^{-1}(A) \in \mathcal{H}$ for A belonging to a collection generating $\mathcal{E}$, for example, a p-system.

Proposition 24. Let $(\Omega, \mathcal{H})$, $(\mathbb{R}, \mathfrak{B}(\mathbb{R}))$ be measurable spaces. Then $X : \Omega \to \mathbb{R}$ is a random variable if and only if

$$X^{-1}((-\infty, r]) := \{\omega \in \Omega : X(\omega) \leq r\} \in \mathcal{H}.$$

Proof. $(\Longrightarrow)$ is trivial; $(\Longleftarrow)$ is also trivial, since it is easy to see the collection $\{r \in \mathbb{R} : (-\infty, r]\}$ is a p-system generating $\mathbb{R}$. □

Example 5 (Coin toss)**.** Consider we toss a coin, denote H as the event that a head shows up and T as the event that a tail shows up. Then $\Omega = \{H, T\}$, and $\mathcal{H} = \{\varnothing, \{H\}, \{T\}, \{H, T\}\}$. Define

$$X(\omega) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } \omega = H \\ 0 & \text{if } \omega = T \end{cases},$$

then we claim that X is a random variable. To see this, take any $r \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$X^{-1}((-\infty, r]) = \begin{cases} \varnothing & \text{if } r < 0 \\ \{T\} & \text{if } 0 \leq r < 1 \\ \{H, T\} & \text{if } r \geq 1 \end{cases},$$

and clearly $\varnothing, \{T\}, \{H, T\} \in \mathcal{H}$.

We say a random variable X is **simple**, if it takes only finitely many values in E; it is said to be **discrete** if it takes countably many values in E.

Definition 25 (Distribution)**.** Let $(\Omega, \mathcal{H}, \mathbb{P})$ be a probability space, $(E, \mathcal{E})$ be a measurable space. If $X : \Omega \to E$ is a random variable, we define the **pushforward measure** (of $\mathbb{P}$ under X) on $(E, \mathcal{E})$ as

$$\mathbb{P} \circ X^{-1}(A) = \mathbb{P}(X^{-1}(A)) = \mathbb{P}(\omega \in \Omega : X(\omega) \in A), \quad \forall A \in \mathcal{E}.$$

The measure $\mu(A) := \mathbb{P} \circ X^{-1}(A)$ is called the **distribution** of X.

By monotone class theorem, it also suffices to specify μ on a p-system generating $\mathcal{E}$. If we take $(E, \mathcal{E}) = (\overline{\mathbb{R}}, \mathfrak{B}(\overline{\mathbb{R}}))$, then we say

$$F(x) = \mu[-\infty, x] = \mathbb{P}(X \leq x)^{1}$$

is the **distribution function** of X.

Proposition 25. Let $X : \Omega \to \overline{\mathbb{R}}$ be a random variable, $F(x)$ be the distribution function of X. Then

- $F(-\infty) = 0, F(\infty) = 1$;
- $F(x)$ is non-decreasing, right continuous, with left limits.

We denote the class of functions F that is is right continuous with left limits as **Càdlàg functions**, which stands for "continue à droite, limite à gauche[2]".

[1] For notation simplicity, it means $\mathbb{P}(\omega \in \Omega : X(\omega) \leq x)$.

[2] Right continuous with left limit in French, it is also denoted as RCLL functions.

2.2 Expectations

Throughout this section, let $(\Omega, \mathcal{H}, \mathbb{P})$ be a probability space, and $X : \Omega \to \overline{\mathbb{R}}$ be a real-valued random variable (unless specified otherwise). Since $\mathbb{P}$ is a measure on $(\Omega, \mathcal{H})$, we are naturally interested in the integral of X with respect to $\mathbb{P}$ (a random variable is indeed a measurable function).

Definition 26 (Expectation)**.** The expected value of X, is defined as the integral of X with respect to $\mathbb{P}$. That is,

$$\mathbb{E}X = \int \mathbb{P}(d\omega)X(\omega).$$

We say $\mathbb{E}X$ exists if and only if $\int \mathbb{P}(d\omega)X(\omega)$ exists.
Since expectation is an integral, so properties of integral can be applied here:

Proposition 26. The expectation satisfies the following properties:

- **Positivity**: If $X \geq 0$, then $\mathbb{E}X \geq 0$;
- **Monotonicity**: If $X \geq Y \geq 0$, then $\mathbb{E}X \geq \mathbb{E}Y$;
- **Linearity**: If $X, Y \geq 0$, $a, b \in \mathbb{R}_+$, then $\mathbb{E}[aX + bY] = a\mathbb{E}X + b\mathbb{E}Y$;
- **Intensitivity**: If $X = Y$ almost surely, then $\mathbb{E}X = \mathbb{E}Y$;
- **Monotone convergence theorem**: If $\{X_n\} \geq 0$ and $X_n \nearrow X$, then $\mathbb{E}[\lim_n X_n] = \lim_n \mathbb{E}[X_n]$;
- **Fatou's lemma**: If $\{X_n\} \geq 0$, then $\liminf_n \mathbb{E}[X_n] \geq \mathbb{E}[\liminf_n X_n]$;
- **Dominated convergence theorem**: If $|X_n| \leq Y$ where $\mathbb{E}|Y| < \infty$ and $\lim_n X_n$ exists, then $\mathbb{E}[\lim_n X_n] = \lim_n \mathbb{E}[X_n]$.

Since $\mathbb{E}[a] = a$ if a is a constant, so dominated convergence theorem can be extended to any finite numbers. That is, if $a < \infty$ and $|X_n| < a$ for all a, when $\lim_n X_n$ exists, we have $\lim_n \mathbb{E}[X_n] = \mathbb{E}[\lim_n X_n]$.

Theorem 13. Let $(E, \mathcal{E})$ be a measurable space and Let $X : \Omega \to E$ be a random variable, if μ is the distribution of X, then for any $\mathcal{E}_+$ measurable functions f,

$$\mathbb{E}f \circ X = \mu(f).$$

Conversely, if $\mathbb{E}f \circ X = \mu(f)$ for some measure μ and all $\mathcal{E}_+$ measurable function f, then μ is the unique distribution of X.

Proof. The first part is a consequence of Theorem 10, where we have

$$\mu(f) = \mathbb{P} \circ X^{-1}(f) = \mathbb{P}(f \circ X)^{3} = \mathbb{E}f \circ X.$$

If $\mathbb{E}f \circ X = \mu(f)$ for all $f \in \mathcal{E}_+$, let $f = \mathbb{1}_A$ for any $A \in \mathcal{E}$, we have

$$\mu(A) = \mathbb{E}\mathbb{1}_A \circ X = \mathbb{P}(X \in A).$$

□

[3] here, it means the integral of $f \circ X$ with respect to the measure $\mathbb{P}$.

2.3 Joint distributions

Let $(E_n, \mathcal{E}_n)$ be measurable spaces, where $n = 1, \cdots, N$, we define the **product space** as

$$(\times_{n=1}^{N} E_n, \bigotimes_{n=1}^{N} \mathcal{E}_n),$$

where $\times_n E_n = E_1 \times E_2 \times \cdots \times E_n$ consists all tuples $(x_1, \cdots, x_N)$ where $x_n \in E_n$. The σ-algebra generated on it, denote as $\bigotimes_n \mathcal{E}_n$ is the σ-algebra generated by all the measurable rectangles of the form $A_1 \times \cdots \times A_N$, where $A_n \in \mathcal{E}_n$. i.e,

$$\bigotimes_{n=1}^{N} \mathcal{E}_n := \sigma\{A_1 \times \cdots \times A_N : A_n \in \mathcal{E}_n, \forall n\}.$$

Proposition 27. Suppose $f_n : \Omega \to E_n$ is ($\mathcal{H}$-) measurable for all $n \in [N]$. Denote $\mathcal{H}; \mathcal{E}_n$ as the σ-algebra generated by Ω, E_n respectively. Then the function $f : \times_n \Omega \to \times_n E_n$ defined by

$$f(\omega) = (f_1(\omega), \cdots, f_N(\omega))$$

is ($\mathcal{H}$-) measurable.

Proof. Let $A_n \in \mathcal{E}_n$ for all $n \in [N]$, then by definition,

$$\begin{aligned} f^{-1}(\times_n A_i) &= \{\omega \in \Omega : f_1(\omega) \in A_1, \cdots, f_N(\omega) \in A_n\} \\ &= \bigcap_{n=1}^{N} \{\omega \in \Omega : f_n(\omega) \in A_n\} \in \mathcal{H}. \end{aligned}$$

□

Hence, if $X_1, \cdots, X_n$ are random variables defined on the probability space $(\Omega, \mathcal{H}, \mathbb{P})$, then $X = (X_1, \cdots, X_n)$ is also a random variable. We denote $\pi = \mathbb{P} \circ X^{-1}$ the **joint distribution** of $X_1, \cdots, X_n$. For $A = \times_n A_n \in \bigotimes_n \mathcal{E}_n$,

$$\pi(A) = \mathbb{P} \circ X^{-1}(A) = \mathbb{P}(X_1^{-1} A_1 \cap \cdots \cap X_n^{-1} A_n) = \mathbb{P}(X_1 \in A_1, \cdots, X_n \in A_n).$$

Note that monotone class theorem also applies here: That is, the distribution $\mathbb{P} \circ X^{-1}$ is uniquely determined by $\mathbb{P} \circ X^{-1}(A)$ for measurable rectangles A, since the collection of all measurable rectangles forms a p-system.

Given random variables $X_1, \cdots, X_n : \Omega \to E_i, i \in [n]$ and $X = (X_1, \cdots, X_n)$, we define the **marginal distribution** of X_i as

$$\mathbb{P}(X_i \in A_i) = \mathbb{P} \circ X^{-1}(E_1 \times \cdots \times E_{i-1} \times A_i \times E_{i+1} \times \cdots \times E_n).$$

It can be shown that the marginal distribution of X_i is also simply the pushforward measure $\mathbb{P} \circ X_i^{-1}$. This shows us that we have two ways to compute the marginal distribution: One is to find the joint distribution and integrate out all the irrelevant random variables, or we simply ignore all other random variables and find the distribution of X_i itself.

So far we only talked about the product space over finite index, we would like to extend the concept to infinite (possibly uncountable) product spaces.

Definition 27. Let T be an arbitrary index set, and for each $t \in T$, let $(E_t, \mathcal{E}_t)$ be a measurable space. Let $(x_t)_{t\in T}$ be the collection of all values $x_t \in E_t$, and the set of all such collections is the **product space** $F = \times_{t\in T} E_t$. A measurable rectangle in F is a subset of the form

$$\times_{t\in T} A_t = \{x \in F : x_t \in A_t \text{ for each } t \in T\},$$

such that $A_t \in \mathcal{E}_t$ for all $t \in T$, and all but finitely many $t \in T$ satisfy $A_t = E_t$[4]. The σ-algebra generated by all measurable rectangles is the **product σ-algebra** denoted by $\bigotimes_{t\in T} \mathcal{E}_t$.

In the special case that $(E_t, \mathcal{E}_t) = (E, \mathcal{E})$ for all $t \in T$, we simply denote the product space as $(E^T, \mathcal{E}^T)$ (or $(E, \mathcal{E})^T$). Suppose $(\Omega, \mathcal{H}, \mathbb{P})$ is the probability space and $\{X_t : t \in T\}$ is a collection of random variables where $X_t : \Omega \to E$, we also denote $(X_t)_{t\in T}$ as a **stochastic process**.

We previously have seen that if we have a finite collection of measurable functions, then their product is measurable. This result also extends to infinite product spaces.

Proposition 28. Let $(\Omega, \mathcal{H})$ be a measurable space, T be a arbitrary index set, for each $t \in T$ let $(E_t, \mathcal{E}_t)$ be a measurable space and $f_t : \Omega \to E_t$ a function. Then $f(\omega) = (f_t(\omega)_{t\in T}$ is measurable (with respect to $\mathcal{H}, \bigotimes_{t\in T} \mathcal{E}_t$) if and only if f_t is measurable for all $t \in T$.

Proof. First suppose f is measurable. Then for any $A \in \bigotimes_{t\in T} \mathcal{E}_t$, we have $f^{-1}(A) \in \mathcal{H}$. For each $t \in T$, define $A = \bigotimes_{t'\in T} A_{t'}$ where $A_{t'} = E_{t'}$ for all $t' \neq t$. Hence by marginal rule $f^{-1}(A) = f_t^{-1}(A_t) \in \mathcal{H}$ for each $t \in T$; On the other hand, assume f_t is measurable for all $t \in T$, then $\bigotimes_{t\in T} \mathcal{E}_t$ is generated by all measurable rectangles, where by definition all but finitely many indices satisfy $A_t = E_t$. Hence for all $A \in \bigotimes_{t\in T} A_t$,

$$f^{-1}(A) = \bigcap_{t\in T_0} f_t^{-1}(A_t),$$

where $A_t \subset E_t$ and T_0 is a finite sub-collection of T. Since each f_t is measurable, finite intersection of them is again measurable. □

Definition 28. For measurable space $(\Omega, \mathcal{H}), (E, \mathcal{E})$ and a random variable $X : \Omega \to E$, the σ-algebra generated by X is defined by

$$\sigma X := X^{-1}\mathcal{E} = \{X^{-1}(A) : A \in \mathcal{E}\}.$$

It is straightforward to verify that σX is indeed a σ-algebra. We may extend this concept to the σ-algebra generated by a collection of random variables:

Definition 29. The σ-algebra generated by an arbitrary collection of random variables $(X_t)_{t\in T}$, where $X_t : \Omega \to E_t$ is given by

$$\sigma\{X_t : t \in T\} = \bigvee_{t\in T} \sigma X_t = \sigma\left(\bigcup_{t\in T} \sigma X_t\right).$$

Proposition 29. If $X = (X_t)_{t\in T}$, then $\sigma X = \sigma\{X_t : t \in T\}$.

Theorem 14. Given $(\Omega, \mathcal{H}), (E, \mathcal{E})$ as measurable spaces, let $X : \Omega \to E$ be a random variable, and a function $Y : \Omega \to \bar{\mathbb{R}}$. Then $Y \in \sigma X$ if and only if $Y = f \circ X$ for some ($\mathcal{E}$-) measurable function f.

Proposition 30. Let T be an arbitrary index set, for each $t \in T$, let $X_t : \Omega \to E_t$ be a random variable. A function $Y : \Omega \to \bar{\mathbb{R}}$ if and only if there exists a sequence $\{t_n\} \subset T$ and a $\bigotimes_n \mathcal{E}_{t_n}$-) measurable function f such that $Y = f(X_{t_1}, \cdots)$.

[4]This means, the collection $\{t \in T : A_t \neq E_t\}$ is finite.

2.4 Independence

3 Bibliography

References

[1] Sheldon Axler. *Measure, Integration and Real Analysis*. Vol. 282. Graduate Texts in Mathematics.

[2] Erhan Çinlar. *Probability and Stochastics*. Vol. 261. Graduate Texts in Mathematics.

[3] Jiajun Zhang. *MATH 454 Lecture Notes: Honors Real Analysis 3*. McGill University, 2024.